

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

CONTENT

- Let's Start! • Let's Explore! • Let's Practice! • Extension Activity • Target Words • Learning Points



Let's Start!

Let's find out how a person can fix a back problem.



Learning Outcome

Understand actions, events, and experiences in present, past or future and in spoken or written texts and in work and social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- Have you ever had a work-related injury?
- What's the best way to avoid back pain for those who work at a desk all day?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about health and wellness.
- I can talk about the reason of an action or an event.
- I can express what is said to have happened or report statements.





Let's Explore!

More than just a **home remedy***.

* A "home remedy" is a cure invented by regular people as opposed medical researchers.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Because she is a computer programmer, Sherri is required to sit at a desk all day long. Since her posture is far from perfect, she was not surprised when she began to notice pain in her neck and shoulders. She assumed that she would probably have to learn to live with the problem, seeing as she worked long hours and that her job was stressful. She got a prescription for pain medication from her doctor and visited a good masseuse when the ache in her neck got very bad.

One day, seeing that Sherri was holding her neck stiffly, one of the other programmers asked her what was wrong. Sherri told him about her chronic neck and shoulder pain. "Have you tried the Alexander technique?" he asked.

Sherri had heard of the Alexander technique. It was said to be an effective cure, but she thought it was for those freaky, "alternative" types of people.

The Alexander technique is said to have been invented by F. M. Alexander (1869-1955). After almost losing his voice from laryngitis, Alexander, who was reported to have been an extraordinary Shakespearean actor, tried to find a way to strengthen his voice without conventional medical care. He carefully watched himself while speaking. He noticed that he was tightening his neck muscles so much that he could actually see the tension. When he learned to reduce neck tension and lengthen his spine, his vocal problem disappeared. From his own experience and his work with others, Alexander is said to have created a teaching method that encourages the body to work more efficiently and holistically.

The Alexander technique is not easy, but it is said to be worth the effort. After using the technique for a year, Sherri has stopped complaining. "I still put in crazy hours at work and spend a lot of time at the computer," says Sherri, "but now when I notice that my neck is beginning to ache, I stop, think of what I learned, and adjust the way I'm sitting. I can feel the tension move up and out of me."





Let's Practice!

Did you know anything about the Alexander technique?

Instructions: Complete the sentences below by choosing from the options that you are given. Practice saying the complete sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

is said to have been

was reported to

was said to be

but it is said to be worth

is said to have created

1. The Alexander technique _____ an effective cure.
2. The Alexander technique _____ invented by F. M. Alexander.
3. Alexander _____ have been an extraordinary Shakespearean actor.
4. Alexander _____ a teaching method that encourages the body to work more efficiently and holistically.
5. The Alexander technique is not easy, _____ the effort.



Let's Practice!

What reasons seem to justify Sherri's pain?

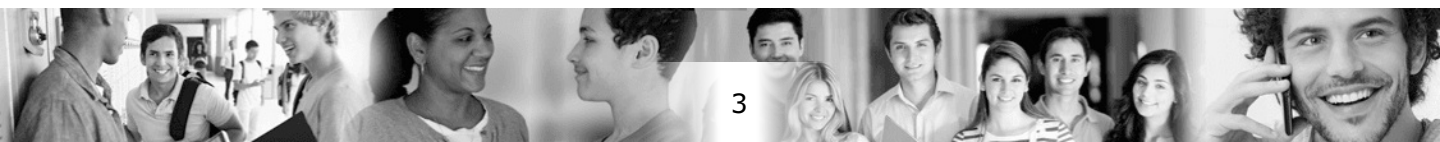
Instructions: Match the sentences on the left with their missing parts on the right. Read the complete sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

COLUMN A

1. Because she is a computer programmer,
2. Since her posture is far from perfect,
3. She assumed she would probably need to learn to live with the problem,
4. One day seeing that Sherri was holding her neck stiffly,
5. Since Sherri had heard about the Alexander technique,

COLUMN B

- a. one of the other programmers asked her what was wrong.
- b. Sherri is required to sit at a desk all day long.
- c. she was not surprised when she began to notice pain in her neck and shoulders.
- d. she decided to give it a try.
- e. seeing as she worked long hours and that her job was stressful.





Extension Activity

Write a step-by-step guide to the Alexander Technique.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Go online and research "The Alexander Technique."
- Write a step-by-step guide explaining how to do at least three different exercises.
- Using your guide, explain the three exercises to a partner.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I research the Alexander Technique.

☐ ☐

I write a step-by-step guide.

☐ ☐

I explain the guide to a partner.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **prescription** (noun): a doctor's written order for medication
e.g. She got a prescription for pain medication from her doctor.
- **pain medication** (noun): a drug used to reduce pain
e.g. She took the pain medication because of her sore back.
- **masseuse** (noun): a person who gives a massage
e.g. She saw a masseuse every week.
- **ache** (noun): a pain that is continuous but not necessarily strong
e.g. She visited a good masseuse when the ache in her neck got very bad.
- **stiffly** (adverb): in a rigid manner
e.g. One day, seeing that Sherri was holding her neck stiffly, one of the other programmers asked her what was wrong.
- **chronic** (adjective): recurring
e.g. Sherri told him about her chronic neck and shoulder pain.
- **laryngitis** (noun): an infection of the larynx
e.g. After almost losing his voice from laryngitis, Alexander tried to find a way to strengthen his voice without conventional medical care.
- **to lengthen** (verb): to make longer
e.g. When he learned to reduce neck tension and lengthen his spine, his vocal problem disappeared.
- **spine** (noun): the bones that run down the center of the back; backbone
e.g. He found that his spine had become twisted over the years.
- **holistically** (adverb): relating to the entire system instead of the individual parts
e.g. Alexander is said to have created a teaching method that encourages the body to work more efficiently and holistically.





Learning Points

Giving Reasons

You use reason clauses to express the reasons for an action, or why a situation is the way it is.

You use words like *because*, *since*, *as*, *in case*, and *seeing that* to introduce a reason clause.

Reason clauses are subordinate to the main clause. They state the reason why things are done, or what makes a situation the way it is.

You can use the following words to introduce a reason clause:

UseConnector	Use	Example
because	to explain why something is the way it is	Because she is a computer programmer, Sherri is required to sit at a desk all day long.
since/as	to introduce a reason that is already known	Since her posture is far from perfect, she was not surprised when she began to notice pain in her neck and shoulders.
(just) in case	to talk about things that may possibly happen	I came over in case you needed some extra help.
seeing that	to state that a situation is known	Seeing that you're here early, we'll be done before noon.

Read the following examples from the text:

Examples:

- *She assumed that she would probably have to learn to live with the problem, seeing as she worked long hours and that her job was stressful.*
- *One day, seeing that Sherri was holding her neck stiffly, one of the other programmers asked her what was wrong.*



Learning Points

Personal Passive vs Impersonal Passive

You use the passive voice when the subject of a sentence is receiving an action rather than doing an action.

You use the Impersonal Passive to report events in a more general, formal way.

A passive sentence puts the emphasis on the object of the active sentence. When you use a passive sentence to report an event, the object of the active sentence now becomes the subject and focus of the passive sentence.

You make the passive form of a verb by using tenses of the verb *to be* followed by the past participle.

For example:

Active sentence: *The doctor gave Sherri a pain medication prescription .*

Passive sentence: *Sherri was given a pain medication prescription by her doctor.*

You can use the Passive form to report events in an impersonal way. The subject is not specific, but general.

You use expressions like *It is said, It is reported* to introduce the Impersonal Passive form.

Example:

It is said that the Alexander technique was developed by an actor, F.M Alexander.

Examples:

- *The Alexander technique is said to have been invented by F. M. Alexander (1869-1955).*
- *Alexander, who was reported to have been an extraordinary Shakespearean actor, tried to find a way to strengthen his voice without conventional medical care.*
- *Alexander is said to have created a teaching method that encourages the body to work more efficiently and holistically.*
- *The Alexander technique is not easy, but it is said to be worth the effort.*

